Toronto 7T MRI Opening Scientific Symposium – Tentative Agenda (speakers confirmed, order and sessions may change)

Thursday October 22, 2026 (Day 1)

8:00–9:00 AM — **Registration, Continental Breakfast & Networking**
Lower Courtyard Ballroom

9:00–9:30 AM — **Opening Remarks**

- Andy Smith, MD, MSc – President & CEO, Sunnybrook Health Science Centre
- Micheal Kolios, PhD – Vice President, Research & Innovation, Sunnybrook Health Sciences Centre
- Jennifer Gommerman, PhD – Co-PI of the TOronto Neuro-Immunology/Imaging Consortium (TONIIC), Professor, Temerty Faculty of Medicine, University of Toronto
- Kullervo Hynynen, PhD – Lead PI of the TONIIC, Senior Scientist, Sunnybrook Research Institute, University of Toronto

9:30–10:15 AM — **Keynote — Kâmil Uğurbil, PhD — Centre for Magnetic Resonance Research, University of Minnesota**
Pushing magnetic fields, resolution, and precision in pursuit of understanding Human Brain Function

10:15–11:00 AM — **Keynote — Erik Middlebrooks, MD – Mayo Clinic**
From Boutique to Bedside: Transforming 7T MRI Into a Clinical Scanner

11:00–11:30 AM — **Coffee Break**
Tour of the 7T Facility (600 m/10-minute walk)

11:30 AM–12:15 PM — **Keynote – Nir Lipsman, MD, PhD – Sunnybrook Health Science Centre, University of Toronto**
From research to clinical care: the value of 7T for Sunnybrook and Toronto

12:15–12:45 PM — **Tour of the 7T Facility (600 m/10-minute walk)**
End of Public Portion

12:30–1:30 PM — **Networking Lunch for In-Person Attendees**
Lower Courtyard Ballroom

1:30–3:00 PM — **Session I – Added value of 7T for clinical research 1**
Moderated by: Alexandre Boutet, MD, PhD – University Health Network, University of Toronto

- Siegfried Trattnig, PhD – Medical University of Vienna
  Advanced MRI of Multiple Sclerosis by Ultrahigh Field MR (7 Tesla)

- Seth Smith, PhD – Center for Human Imaging, Vanderbilt University Institute of Imaging Science
  Advanced spinal cord and brain biomarkers 7T in Multiple Sclerosis
- Mary Jane Lim-Fat, MD – Sunnybrook Health Science Centre, University of Toronto
  Cancer research at 7T for the Odette Cancer Centre
- Benjamin Davidson, MD, PhD – Sunnybrook Health Science Centre, University of Toronto
  Subcortex in obsessive-compulsive disorder: What it means to see at 7T
- Sriranga Kashyap, PhD – Sunnybrook Research Institute, University of Toronto
  Lowering Barriers at Ultra-high-field: Optimised protocols for 7T MRI

3:00–3:30 PM **Coffee Break**

Tour of the 7T Facility (600 m/10-minute walk)

3:30–5:00 PM **Session II – Advanced image acquisition at 7T**

Moderated by: Lars Kasper, PhD – Toronto Neuroimaging Facility, University of Toronto

- Julien Cohen-Adad, PhD – École Polytechnique de Montréal
  Advancing Spinal Cord MRI at 7T with Hybrid AC/DC Coils and Real-Time Dynamic Shimming
- Jonathan Polimeni, PhD – Stanford School of Medicine, Stanford University
  Advanced functional and physiological MRI at 7T
- Tony Stoecker, PhD – German Center for Neurodegenerative Diseases (DZNE)
  Fast and robust high-resolution brain imaging at 7T

Friday October 23, 2026 (Day 2)

8:30–9:00 AM **Continental Breakfast & Networking**

Lower Courtyard Ballroom

9:00–10:30 AM **Keynote – 7T Experience Across Canada**

Moderated by: Mark Chiew, PhD – Sunnybrook Research Institute, University of Toronto

- Ravi Menon, PhD – Centre for Functional and Metabolic Mapping, Western University
  Three decades of human ultra-high field MRI in Canada: The London Experience
- Christine Tardif, PhD – The Neuro (McConnell Brain Imaging Centre), McGill University
  From Hardware to Human Neuroscience: Building a 7T MRI Program at The Neuro (The Montreal Experience)

- Simon Graham, PhD – Sunnybrook Research Institute, University of Toronto
  The road to 7T in the GTA: The Toronto Experience
- Robin Heidemann, PhD – Siemens Healthineers
  Discover - Translate – Apply

10:30–11:00 AM **Coffee Break**

Tour of the 7T Facility (600 m/10-minute walk)

11:00 AM–12:30 PM **Session III – Clinical applications across disorders and diseases**

Moderated by: Kimberly Desmond, PhD – Centre for Addiction and Mental Health, University of Toronto

- Rosanna Olsen, PhD – Baycrest Academy for Research and Education, University of Toronto
  Using high-resolution time of flight MR-angiography to image the hippocampal blood supply
- Erin Beck, MD, PhD – Icahn School of Medicine at Mount Sinai, New York
  Multiple sclerosis imaging at 7T
- Noam Harel, MD, PhD – Centre for Magnetic Resonance Research (CMRR), University of Minnesota
  A Clearer Vision for DBS: The 7T MRI Advantage

12:30–1:30 PM **Networking Lunch**

Lower Courtyard Ballroom

1:30–3:00 PM **Session IV – Added value of 7T for clinical research 2**

Moderated by: Jean Chen, PhD – Baycrest Academy for Research and Education, University of Toronto

- Maxime Guye, MD, PhD – Centre for Magnetic Resonance in Biology and Medicine, Aix-Marseille University
  Beyond the Surface: 7T MRI and the Hidden Dimensions of Epilepsy
- Marta Bianciardi, PhD – Harvard Medical School, Massachusetts General Hospital (MGH)
  From nuclei to networks: A 7 Tesla journey into the human brainstem
- Jamie Near, PhD – Sunnybrook Research Institute, University of Toronto
  Magnetic Resonance Spectroscopy and shimming at 7T
- Ying Meng, MD, PhD – Sunnybrook Health Science Centre, University of Toronto
  Blood brain barrier permeability in focused ultrasound patients at 3T and 7T
- Jennifer Rabin, PhD, C.Psych – Sunnybrook Research Institute, University of Toronto
  7T and Women's Brain Health

3:00–3:30 PM **Coffee Break**

Tour of the 7T Facility (600 m/10-minute walk)

3:30–5:00 PM **Session V – Emerging sequences and applications**

Moderated by: Andrea Kassner, PhD – SickKids Research Institute, University of Toronto

- Mark Ladd, PhD – German Cancer Research Center (DKFZ)
  Toward whole-body 7T imaging with conventional workflow
- Uzay Emir, PhD – University of Northern Carolina
  PETALUTE at 7T – From fundamental research in metabolic imaging to AD
- Kâmil Uludağ, PhD – Sunnybrook Research Institute, University of Toronto
  Opportunities and Challenges of Perfusion Imaging at 7T